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M:Audience Research

1. Industry Terminology and Language:

How do our customers typically **describe their business or industry**? Do they identify as "field services," "manufacturing," "retail," etc.?

Manufacturing, Warehousing and Distribution (MWD)

1. Typically identified as **Manufacturing, Warehousing, and Distribution (MWD)**.
2. Includes companies dealing with **industrial supplies, B2B sales, production planning, inventory management, supply chain management**.

Field Services and Construction (FS)

1. Generally identified as **Field Services** or **Field Service & Construction**.
2. Specific roles mentioned: **HVAC Technicians, Contractors, Service Providers**.
3. Tools mentioned: **QuickBooks, Excel**.
4. Construction: Identified as **Construction**, **Field Services**, and sometimes even **Professional Services**.

IT Professionals (IT Pro)

Typically identified as **IT and computer related companies, Consulting and professional companies, or Managed Service Providers** (MSPs are companies that outsource IT and other business functions like supply chain management, marketing or HR).

- **Common tasks** handled by MSPs include IT support (network management, data backup, security), human resources (onboarding, payroll), marketing (strategy and content), and supply chain management (sourcing, procurement).

Do our customers use **specific terms** or jargon that help us identify the industries they belong to? What terms or phrases do they use when discussing their needs or pain points?

Manufacturing, Warehousing and Distribution (MWD)

- Bill of Materials (BOM)
- Just-in-Time (JIT)
- Work-in-Progress (WIP)
- Capacity Utilization
- Supply Chain Management (SCM)
- Sales and Quoting
- ERP Integration.

Multi-Entity Operations

- Custom Architecture
- SKU Tracking
- Bi-Directional Sync with QuickBooks
- Inventory Moving
- Field Crew App (yes, in MWD as well)
- Work Orders App (yes, in MWD as well)
- Enterprise Integration
- B2C Hand-to-Hand Purchases.

Mention of http://Authorize.net for payment processing and **QuickBooks integration**.

Field Services and Construction (FS)

- Work Orders
- Dispatching
- Technician Scheduling
- Service Tickets
- Mobile Access
- Route Optimization.

Construction:

- Project Bidding
- Subcontractor Management
- Progress Invoicing
- Site Documentation
- Punch Lists
- Change Orders.

IT Professionals (IT Pro)

- Service Level Agreements (SLAs)
- Asset Management
- Recurring Invoices
- IT Support

- Ticketing Systems.

What are the **most common challenges** our customers mention when they reach out to us during the sales process?

Manufacturing, Warehousing and Distribution (MWD)

- **Demand Mismatch:** Overproduction or shortages due to inaccurate demand forecasting.
- **Fragmented Order Data:** Difficulty tracking client preferences and order history across multiple systems.
- **ERP Integration Problems:** Lack of synchronization between production schedules and sales data.
- **Inconsistent Quoting:** Errors due to lack of standardization in quotes.
- **Lack of Insights:** Inability to identify inefficiencies or trends due to insufficient reporting tools.
- **Customization Needs:** Chose Method CRM over NetSuite and Salesforce due to cost-effectiveness and customization capabilities.
- **Scalability Concerns:** QuickBooks alone could not support growing business needs like managing excise taxes and multi-state operations.
- **Inventory Management:** QuickBooks for inventory handling due to being multi-site.
- **Purchase Order Integration:** Back office comfortable using QuickBooks Enterprise for purchase orders.

Field Services and Construction (FS)

Most common challenges during the sales process:

1. **Limited QuickBooks Capabilities:** Need to manage sales, invoicing, and customer data without investing in full ERP solutions.
2. **Lead and Customer Tracking:** Difficulty in tracking leads, customers, and sales team performance (28% of demos booked).
3. **Manual Data Entry:** Wasting time and risking errors with duplicate data entry (16% of demos booked).
4. **Excel Dependency:** Over-reliance on spreadsheets creating inefficiencies (7% of demos booked).

   Construction: Most common challenges during the sales process:
   - Managing complex **projects and bids**.
   - Keeping track of **subcontractor schedules and materials**.
   - Synchronizing **invoices and payments** with job progress.

IT and Professional services (IT/Pro)

1. Lack of centralized ticketing and case management systems.
2. Difficulty tracking billable hours and recurring contracts.
3. Synchronizing data between service tickets and financial records.

Are there any **key industry-specific issues** that tend to surface repeatedly across different verticals?

Manufacturing, Warehousing and Distribution (MWD)

- High reliance on **integrating CRM with ERP systems** for smoother workflow.
- Need for **real-time inventory management** to avoid overstocking or understocking.
- **Automation and data visibility** are recurring themes in manufacturing and distribution.
- Fragmented systems, with a need for a **bi-directional sync with QuickBooks**.
- Difficulty in handling **multi-entity operations**.
- Challenges with **scaling without sacrificing customization and cost-efficiency**.
- Integration challenges with external tools like **Clover POS and Authorize.net**.

Field Services and Construction (FS)

5. Dependence on **mobile accessibility** for on-the-go CRM use.
6. Concerns about **scalability** without additional hires.

   Construction:

7. Fragmented systems for managing jobs, contractors, and financials.
8. Poor visibility into project status and performance.

IT Professionals (IT Pro)

1. Need for **automated billing and renewal reminders**.
2. Challenges in **tracking assets and devices** across multiple clients.

3. Software Preferences (TechStack):

What **other software** do our prospects or customers mention using in conjunction with our solution (besides QuickBooks)?

Manufacturing, Warehousing and Distribution (MWD)

- Some companies may be exploring **ERP systems** to handle manufacturing-specific needs.
- Heavy use of **Excel** for manual processes.
- **QuickBooks Desktop:** Primary tool for inventory management, purchase orders, and payment processing.
- **Clover POS:** Not bi-directional with QuickBooks.
- **Authorize.net:** Used for Method CRM payments.
- **Square:** Sometimes used alongside Clover POS for transactions.

Field Services and Construction (FS)

1. **QuickBooks** (primary software), **Xero** (alternative).
2. Heavy reliance on **Excel** for various processes.
3. CompanyCam (CompanyCam - The only app every contractor needs)

   Construction: **QuickBooks**, **Excel**, and **Construction-specific software** (e.g., Procore, Buildertrend).

IT and Professionals (IT/Pro)

Do customers ever mention or ask about **other tools** (e.g., accounting software, inventory systems, etc.)?

Manufacturing, Warehousing and Distribution (MWD)

Field Services and Construction (FS)

IT Professionals (IT Pro)

4. Customer Sentiment Toward QuickBooks:

What do our prospects or customers say about their **current use of QuickBooks**? Are they happy with it, or do they express frustration with it? If so, what specifically?

1. Are prospects considering leaving QuickBooks for another solution? If so, what are their reasons?

Manufacturing, Warehousing and Distribution (MWD)

- Effective for **accounting purposes**, but not robust enough for managing **production schedules, inventory levels, or sales forecasting**.
- QuickBook is effective for inventory management due to **multi-site support**.
- Back office prefers using **QuickBooks Enterprise for purchase orders**.
- Lacks necessary **B2C transaction capabilities**; they use http://Authorize.net with Method CRM to overcome this.

1. **Reasons for considering alternatives:**
   - Lack of integration with **ERP systems**.
   - Limited ability to provide comprehensive **real-time reporting and insights**.
   - **NetSuite and Salesforce** were considered but found too complex and expensive for the needs of a smaller business.
   - Preference for **Method CRM** due to **cost-effectiveness, customization, and seamless QuickBooks integration**.

Field Services and Construction (FS)

FS: Relied on heavily but perceived as **limited** for specific operational needs like managing service tickets, scheduling, or dispatching.
Reason for change: Desire for more **customization and integration** beyond accounting.

Construction: Often relied on for financial management but lacks **job tracking and project management features**.
Reason for change: Need for a CRM that integrates better with **project-based workflows**.

IT and Professional Services (IT/Pro)

Effective for billing but insufficient for tracking ongoing service contracts or tickets.
Reason for possible alternatives (from QB): Lack of integration with IT service management tools.

5. Industry Events & Associations:

Are there any **key industry events, conferences, or associations** where our customers or prospects frequently attend or participate?

1. Do they belong to any **industry-specific groups or networks** that we could engage with?

Manufacturing, Warehousing and Distribution (MWD)

Blogs, Home Builder's association in New Hampshire, those kind of networks, casual beer and cigar conversations

Field Services and Construction (FS)

- Ontario Trade Show, Kentucky Landscaping Trade Show (EXPO), Landscape Ontario Congress
- For CRM research, relies on experience with large ERP systems.
- Franchisees likely have varied sources.

IT and Professional services (IT/Pro)

6. Common Issues and Pain Points:

What are the **most common issues or challenges** customers face while using our product, especially when integrated with QuickBooks?

1. What **specific features or functionalities** do customers frequently ask about or struggle with?

Manufacturing, Warehousing and Distribution (MWD)

1. **Production Planning:** Struggles with balancing supply and demand effectively.
2. **Inventory Management:** Problems with real-time visibility and tracking.
3. **Data Fragmentation:** Sales and customer data often disconnected from production systems.
4. **Lack of Integration:** Disconnect between **CRM, ERP, and financial tools (like QuickBooks)**.
5. **Limited Reporting Tools:** Poor visibility into performance metrics, efficiency, and trends.

Field Services and Construction (FS)

Manual Processes: Invoicing, customer tracking, and dispatching are manually handled, creating inefficiencies.

Lack of CRM Adoption: Difficulty getting technicians and office staff to consistently use new tools.

Integration Challenges: Need for syncing field activities with back-office systems like QuickBooks.

Construction:

Inconsistent Quoting: Lack of standardization in quotes leading to errors or missed opportunities.

Fragmented Data: Difficulty managing contractors, projects, and customer data in a unified system.

Delayed Reporting: Progress reports from sites are often delayed, causing project inefficiencies.

IT and Professional services (IT/Pro)

1. **Untracked Issues:** Tickets fall through without a central system.
2. **Missed Invoices:** Inconsistent billing practices, particularly for recurring services.
3. **Asset Tracking:** Difficulty maintaining accurate records for client devices and warranties.

M:Market Research

Manufacturing Industry

How CRM is Used

How CRM is Used	Details	*Example Businesses*
Production Planning	Track customer demand and forecast production needs to avoid overproduction or shortages.	*Tesla – Forecasts demand for EV production.*
Customer Relationship Management	Manage client orders, track order history, and improve customer satisfaction with timely updates.	*GE Appliances – Tracks client orders and ensures timely service.*
Integration with ERP	Synchronize production schedules and inventory levels with sales and customer data.	*Caterpillar – Syncs production with global sales teams.*
Sales and Quoting	Generate accurate quotes, track sales pipelines, and ensure timely follow-ups with leads.	*Siemens – Provides custom quotes for industrial machinery.*
Data-Driven Improvements	Use CRM analytics to identify trends in customer orders and streamline manufacturing workflows.	*John Deere – Analyzes customer orders to optimize production.*

Manufacturing industry pain points

Category	Pain Point	Details	*Real Quote*
Production Planning	Demand Mismatch	Overproduction or shortages due to inaccurate demand forecasting.	*"We need a system that connects customer orders directly to production schedules to avoid wasted resources."*
Customer Management	Fragmented Order Data	Difficulty keeping track of client preferences and order history across multiple systems.	*"I wish I could easily see what a customer has ordered in the past and their preferences at a glance."*
Integration Issues	ERP Integration Problems	Trouble syncing production schedules and sales data for better forecasting.	*"Our CRM doesn't talk to our ERP system, so we're always playing catch-up between production and sales."*
Sales Process Challenges	Inconsistent Quoting	Lack of standardization in quotes, leading to errors or missed opportunities.	*"Sometimes quotes are delayed because we don't have a central way to manage them."*
Data Visibility	Lack of Insights	Insufficient reporting tools to identify inefficiencies or customer trends.	*"I don't have clear data to tell me which product lines are most profitable or where we're losing customers."*

Manufacturing terminologies relevant to CRM systems

Term	Relevance to CRM	*CRM Use Case*
Bill of Materials (BOM)	CRM systems can link BOMs with customer orders to ensure accurate production planning and communication.	*A sales rep can review a customer's order and verify the required materials are in stock.*
Just-in-Time (JIT)	CRM systems integrated with inventory can help track orders and trigger JIT supply needs.	*Automate order alerts to suppliers when inventory dips below a certain threshold.*
Work-in-Progress (WIP)	CRM systems can track WIP status and update customers on production progress.	*Provide real-time production updates to customers through a customer portal.*
Capacity Utilization	CRM dashboards can include data on production capacity to manage customer expectations.	*Sales teams can schedule deliveries based on available manufacturing capacity.*

Supply Chain Management (SCM)	CRM systems can integrate with SCM to ensure customer orders align with supplier capabilities.	*Notify customers proactively if supplier delays impact order timelines.*

Warehousing Industry

How CRM is Used

Category	How CRM is Used	Example Businesses
Order and Inventory Management	• Track stock levels and manage orders. • Integrate with Warehouse Management Systems (WMS).	• Grainger • Local distributors using Zoho CRM.
Customer Relationship Management	• Maintain customer profiles and purchase history. • Offer tailored services and faster resolutions.	• C.H. Robinson • Regional warehousing firms.
Sales and Distribution	• Automate sales pipelines and track performance. • Manage shipping and logistics.	• XPO Logistics • ShipBob.
Data Centralization	• Provide a single source of truth for customer and operational data. • Enable analytics and reporting.	• Wholesale distributors like Grainger.
Automation and Efficiency	• Automate tasks like invoicing and order tracking. • Reduce manual processes.	• ShipBob • Manufacturing firms like John Deere.
Scalability	• Adapt to business growth with additional tools. • Handle larger datasets and customer bases.	• Startups using Method CRM for tailored workflows.

Warehousing industry pain points

Category	Pain Point	Details	Real Quote
Inventory & Orders	Missed Updates	Over-promising or under-stocking due to inventory not being updated in real-time.	*"I need to know exactly how much stock I have at any given moment. One missed update, and I either over-promise to a customer or under-stock a key product."*
	Need for Real-Time Sync	Requires integration between CRM and Warehouse	

		Management Systems (WMS) for accurate tracking.	
Customer Communication	Fragmented Communication	Emails, phone calls, and spreadsheets make it hard to respond quickly to customer inquiries.	*"A customer calls in to check an order, and my team scrambles through multiple systems to figure it out."*
	Need for Centralized Dashboard	A CRM that provides instant access to customer history and order status is crucial.	
Manual Processes	Time-Consuming Tasks	Hours spent manually updating orders, invoices, and follow-up emails.	*"My team spends hours each week manually updating orders, invoices, and follow-up emails."*
	Need for Automation	Automating repetitive tasks allows the team to focus on shipping, sales, and growth.	
Accounting Integration	Difficulty Integrating with QuickBooks	Syncing sales orders and warehouse operations with QuickBooks is often complicated.	*"We use QuickBooks for accounting, but syncing it with sales orders and warehouse operations isn't smooth."*
	Need for Seamless Integration	The CRM should work smoothly with QuickBooks without custom workarounds.	
Shipping & Logistics	Poor Shipment Tracking	Once orders leave the warehouse, there's limited visibility until a customer calls for updates.	*"Once an order leaves the warehouse, it's like it disappears until a customer calls to ask for a delivery status."*
	Need for Integrated Tracking	Tracking progress visible to both customers and team members is essential.	
Customization & Scaling	One-Size-Fits-All Systems	Standard CRMs don't reflect unique business workflows like bulk orders or custom pricing.	*"I'm tired of one-size-fits-all systems. My business is unique—we deal with bulk orders for distributors and retailers."*
	Scalability Issues	Systems must handle larger datasets and growing operational demands without crashing.	*"As we grow, I can't afford downtime or clunky systems that crash with larger datasets."*

Warehousing terminologies relevant to CRM systems

Term	Relevance to CRM	CRM Use Case
Warehouse Management System (WMS)	Integrates with CRM for seamless order and inventory tracking.	Ensures accurate inventory updates and order fulfillment.
Order Picking	CRMs provide real-time order details to streamline picking processes.	Tracks order status and shares updates with customers.
Barcode Scanning	Syncs with CRM to reduce errors and speed up order processing.	Updates order statuses in real time as items are scanned.
Returns Management	Links returns to customer profiles for efficient processing.	Tracks returns, initiates refunds, and updates inventory records.
Cross-Docking	Assists in managing goods that bypass storage for faster delivery.	Provides real-time shipment updates to customers.

Distribution Industry

How CRM is Used

How CRM is Used	Details	Example Businesses
Order and Inventory Management	Track stock levels, manage orders, and reduce errors in fulfillment.	Grainger – Manages industrial supplies inventory.
Route Optimization	Plan delivery schedules efficiently to reduce costs and improve customer satisfaction.	FedEx Supply Chain – Optimizes delivery schedules for faster fulfillment.
Customer Service	Provide timely updates on order status and improve post-sale service with tracking.	C.H. Robinson – Offers real-time updates to clients.
Sales Pipeline Management	Track opportunities, automate follow-ups, and close deals faster with streamlined processes.	Sysco – Tracks B2B sales for food distribution.
Supplier Relationship Management	Manage communication and orders with suppliers to ensure stock availability.	Univar Solutions – Coordinates with chemical suppliers to prevent delays.

Distribution industry pain points

Category	Pain Point	Details	Real Quote
Order Management	Fulfillment Errors	Errors in inventory tracking or order processing that delay shipments.	"Sometimes we send the wrong items because inventory isn't up-to-date. It's embarrassing and costly."
Route Planning	Inefficient Deliveries	Poor delivery scheduling leads to higher costs and customer complaints.	"We lose money when trucks go out half-full or take inefficient routes."

Customer Service	Delayed Order Updates	Customers get frustrated without real-time updates on their orders.	"If a customer asks about their delivery, we often don't have the answer until we check multiple systems."
Sales Management	Lost Opportunities	Sales teams miss follow-ups or lose deals due to disorganized processes.	"We sometimes lose big orders because no one followed up on time."
Supplier Coordination	Stock Delays	Communication gaps with suppliers cause stock shortages or overstock issues.	"If suppliers don't deliver on time, it throws off everything for us and our customers."

Distribution terminologies relevant to CRM systems

Term	Relevance to CRM	CRM Use Case
Third-Party Logistics (3PL)	CRM systems can integrate with 3PLs to provide real-time shipping updates to customers.	Automate email notifications with tracking links once orders ship through a 3PL.
Order Fulfillment	CRM systems can streamline the process by linking order data to inventory and shipping.	Ensure seamless handoff from sales to fulfillment teams, reducing errors in processing.
Last-Mile Delivery	CRMs can track last-mile delivery statuses and share updates with customers.	Enable automated SMS notifications to customers when their delivery is out for shipment.
SKU (Stock Keeping Unit)	CRM systems help track SKUs in orders and identify trends in product sales.	Generate sales reports to identify best-selling SKUs and inform inventory planning.
Demand Forecasting	CRMs can use customer order history to predict future demand and plan inventory.	Use analytics to offer promotions for slow-moving items based on forecasted demand.
EDI (Electronic Data Interchange)	CRMs can integrate with EDI systems to streamline order and invoice processing with suppliers and customers.	Automate order confirmations and invoicing to improve accuracy and reduce manual data entry.

Cross-Referenced CRM Use Across Manufacturing, Distribution, and Warehousing

How does the MWD industry use a CRM?

Category	CRM Use	Relevant Industries	Optimal Messaging
Order Management	Track and manage customer orders, ensuring accuracy and timely updates.	Manufacturing, Distribution, Warehousing	"Ensure every order is accurate, on time, and keeps your customers happy with

			seamless tracking and updates."
Inventory Tracking	Monitor stock levels in real-time to avoid overstock or shortages.	Manufacturing, Distribution, Warehousing	"Stay ahead of demand with real-time inventory visibility, directly connected to your sales and warehouse systems."
Customer Relationship Management	Centralize customer data, order history, and communication for better service.	Manufacturing, Distribution, Warehousing	"Keep your customers at the center of your business with a single system for their orders, preferences, and communications."
Integration with Systems	Sync with ERP, WMS, or shipping systems for streamlined operations.	Manufacturing, Distribution, Warehousing	"Bring all your tools together—inventory, sales, and shipping—so nothing falls through the cracks."
Automation	Automate repetitive tasks like invoicing, order tracking, and follow-ups.	Manufacturing, Distribution, Warehousing	"Save time by automating manual tasks, letting your team focus on growth instead of busywork."
Data Visibility	Provide insights into order trends, sales pipelines, and operational bottlenecks.	Manufacturing, Distribution, Warehousing	"Turn your data into actionable insights to spot trends, improve forecasting, and make smarter decisions."
Sales Pipeline Management	Track leads, automate follow-ups, and close deals faster.	Manufacturing, Distribution	"Never miss a deal—track every opportunity and automate follow-ups to close sales faster."
Returns Management	Handle customer returns efficiently, linking to inventory and customer records.	Distribution, Warehousing	"Streamline your returns process with a system that tracks everything from refund initiation to restocking."
Shipping and Delivery	Provide real-time updates on order shipping and delivery progress.	Distribution, Warehousing	"Keep customers informed with live updates on their shipments, from warehouse to doorstep."

Field Services

How CRM is Used

How CRM is Used	Details	Example Businesses

Job Scheduling & Dispatch	Assign jobs, optimize routes, reduce travel time and missed appointments.	Mr. Handyman – Efficient technician scheduling.
Customer Management	Maintain customer history, service preferences, and communication.	**[Real Customer]** Mobility City – Franchise-wide CRM consistency.
Work Order Management	Create, assign, and track service orders across teams or franchises.	Roto-Rooter – Tracks service tickets in real-time.
QuickBooks Integration	Create invoices on-site, accept payments, sync to QuickBooks.	HVAC repair businesses using Method CRM.
Field Tech Communication	Mobile access to job info and customer history, real-time updates.	Stanley Steemer – Techs update status from the field.

Field Services industry pain points

Category	Pain Point	Details	Sample Quote
Job Assignment	Manual Dispatching	Difficulty assigning jobs efficiently across locations or teams.	"We were printing out work orders and handing them out every morning."
Fragmented Systems	Lack of Unified Data	Locations using their own systems, causing confusion.	"Each franchise was doing their own thing — it was chaos."
Compliance	Inconsistent Usage	Franchises not adopting CRM uniformly.	"Now we can see who's actually using the system and track compliance."
Payment & Invoicing	Delayed Transactions	Slow invoicing from the field leads to cash flow issues.	"It used to take a week before invoices got into QuickBooks."
Customer Follow-up	Missed Opportunities	No automated reminders or follow-up with past customers.	"We had no idea who we hadn't serviced in 6 months — no system for it."

Field Services terminologies relevant to CRM systems

Term	Relevance to CRM	CRM Use Case

Work Orders	Central tool for managing field service tasks.	Dispatch and track completion of services across franchises.
Route Optimization	Reduce travel time and fuel costs.	Schedule multiple stops efficiently for field crews.
Mobile App Access	Enable field techs to update job status on-site.	Update work order status, collect signatures, and send invoices.
Recurring Service Plans	Many FS companies offer scheduled maintenance.	Automate recurring jobs and reminders for customers.
Franchise Compliance	Visibility into franchisee usage and adoption.	Monitor login activity, standardize workflows across franchisees.

Construction

How CRM is Used

How CRM is Used	Details	Example Businesses
Project Bidding	Track bid submissions, deadlines, and follow-ups.	PCL Construction – Manages project bids.
Subcontractor Management	Coordinate schedules, materials, and updates.	Turner Construction – Tracks subs by project.
Client Communication	Maintain job progress updates and site visit logs.	Local contractors using Jobber.
Site Documentation	Capture photos, notes, and inspection results via mobile.	Small builders using Buildertrend.
Progress Invoicing	Generate phased invoices tied to milestones, sync to QuickBooks.	General contractors with long projects.

Construction industry pain points

Category	Pain Point	Details	Sample Quote
Bidding	Missed Opportunities	Lost bids due to lack of follow-ups or documentation.	“We forgot to follow up on a $50K bid, no reminders.”

Job Progress	Poor Visibility	Delayed reporting from site causes decision lags.	"I didn't know that job was two weeks behind until the client called."
Invoice Timing	Delayed Payments	Milestone-based billing not automated, slowing down cash flow.	"Sometimes we don't send invoices for weeks after hitting a milestone."
Subcontractors	Lack of Coordination	Can't easily track subcontractor timelines or materials.	"Subs just text updates, no centralized system."
Change Orders	Disorganized Changes	Verbal change requests not logged properly.	"Too many handshake agreements, it's a nightmare at billing."

Construction terminology relevant to CRM systems

Term	Relevance to CRM	CRM Use Case
RFIs (Requests for Info)	CRM can track incoming and outgoing RFIs tied to project records.	Automate follow-ups on unanswered RFIs.
Submittals	Documentation workflow requiring approvals.	Manage approvals and link to contacts or vendors.
Change Orders	Contract modifications during a project.	Track and approve change orders with date, cost, and scope changes.
Draw Schedules	Progress-based payment structures.	Sync invoices to QuickBooks based on draw schedule milestones.
Punch Lists	Final task checklists before project completion.	Assign and track punch items through CRM tasks.

➡️ IT and Professional services

How CRM is Used

How CRM is Used	Details	Example Businesses
Ticketing & Case Management	Manage support issues, assign to team members, track resolutions.	Small MSPs using Syncro or Method.
Recurring Service Contracts	Automate billing and renewal reminders for monthly services.	IT providers with monthly plans.

Asset Management	Link customer accounts to devices, warranties, and services.	Network maintenance providers.
Time Tracking	Track billable hours per ticket or client.	Managed service providers with retainer.
QuickBooks Integration	Sync service invoices and retainers for streamlined billing.	Bookkeepers and tech consultants.

IT and Professional services industry pain points

Category	Pain Point	Details	Real Quote
Case Management	Untracked Issues	Tickets fall through without a central system.	"Clients would call three times and we'd still forget to close the ticket."
Billing & Retainers	Missed Invoices	Manual time entry leads to missed billable hours.	"We lost money because our team didn't log hours properly."
Renewals	Poor Contract Tracking	Service contracts not tied to calendar events.	"We had no system reminding us to renew monthly support contracts."
Device Tracking	Asset Overload	Hard to track client hardware or software details.	"We didn't know a client's warranty was expired until it broke."
QuickBooks Sync	Manual Entry Issues	Invoices created outside CRM and manually entered in QuickBooks.	"Double entry between systems caused a lot of mistakes."

IT and Professional services terminology relevant to CRM systems

Term	Relevance to CRM	CRM Use Case
Tickets / Cases	Centralize support interactions.	Log, assign, and close IT support tickets.
SLAs (Service Level Agreements)	Track time-to-resolution and enforce performance.	Generate reports on SLA compliance.
Recurring Invoices	Monthly/quarterly billing for ongoing services.	Automate invoicing and renewal reminders.
Asset Tagging	Associate hardware/software with client records.	Keep history of devices, warranties, and service logs.

Knowledge Base	Provide internal help docs or client-facing support articles.	Reduce ticket volume with FAQs.

M:Product Research (TBD)

Most used packs by Industry (Dated: March 2025/past 4 Qs) (TBD)

MWD

packName	Packs Added
Accounting Lists	2
Case Management	8
Companies	1
Contact Management	5
Donor Management	1
Email Campaigns	13
Field Crew	2
Invoice Item Report	1
ProductTracking	1
Proposals	15
Purchase Transactions	14
RMA	1
SaaSphalt	1
Sales Pipeline	3
Sales Transactions	4
Time Tracking	7
Valid Estimates Over 20K	1
Virtual Proofs	1
Work Orders	24
Grand Total	105

Field Services

packName	Packs Added March 2025 (Last 4 Qs)

Accounting Lists	3
Case Management	5
Companies	1
Contact Management	4
Donor Management	2
Email Campaigns	11
Field Crew	3
for xsMapping	1
Proposals	17
Purchase History	1
Purchase Transactions	6
Recurring	1
SaaSphalt	5
SaaSphalt Crew Leader	2
Sales Pipeline	5
Sales Transactions	4
Time Tracking	3
Work Orders	13
Grand Total	87

Construction (Fun fact: Construction is the top-most industry that uses QuickBooks)

packName	Packs Added
Accounting Lists	2
Case Management	8
Contact Management	4
Credit Memos	1
Donor Management	1
Email Campaigns	8
Field Crew	4
Proposals	23

Purchase Transactions	14
SaaSphalt	5
SaaSphalt Crew Leader	4
Sales Pipeline	5
Sales Transactions	4
Time Tracking	6
ToDo	1
Work Orders	23
Grand Total	113

IT/Pro

packName	Packs Added
Case Management	2
Donor Management	2
Email Campaigns	2
Proposals	8
Purchase Transactions	2
Time Tracking	4
Work Orders	10
Grand Total	30

Method's Value Proposition by Industry (Packs/Apps)

MWD Solution

Pack/App	Functionality	*Value to MWD*
Contact Management	Manage customer and vendor relationships.	*Simplifies relationship management for repeat orders and large client/vendor bases.*
Accounting List	Sync accounts, inventory items, and classes.	*Ensures accurate financial and inventory records, reducing errors in stock and cost tracking.*
Sales Transactions	Generate estimates, sales orders, and invoices.	*Streamlines order management and reduces manual entry errors.*

Inventory Tracking	Track stock levels in real-time.	*Improves operational efficiency and customer satisfaction.*
Automation	Automate repetitive tasks like invoicing and follow-ups.	*Saves time and reduces reliance on manual interventions.*
Integration	Sync with QuickBooks, ERP, WMS, or shipping systems.	*Eliminates silos and ensures smooth data flow between departments.*

Field Services Solution

Pack/App	Functionality	Value to Field Services
Work Orders	Manage and track jobs with real-time updates.	Reduce job delays and improve visibility.
Field Crew	Share job details with technicians on the go.	Keep crews informed and jobs running smoothly.
Invoices & Payments	Generate and track invoices seamlessly.	Speed up payment collection and reduce paperwork.
Contact Management	Centralize customer data and service history.	Build better customer relationships and ensure accurate records.
Time Tracking	Log and track billable hours for jobs.	Ensure accurate costing and improve payroll management.

IT/Pro Solution

Pack/App	Functionality	Value to IT/Pros
Proposals	Send estimates, engagement letters, and terms your clients can review, approve, and sign, all online.	Ditch the PDFs and close deals faster with customizable proposals and built-in e-signatures.
Cases	Track and manage customer tickets.	Improve response times and resolve issues faster.
Sales Pipeline	Track leads and automate follow-ups.	Close deals faster with better pipeline visibility.
Contact Management	Centralize client data and project history.	Ensure accurate records and streamline project updates.
Invoices & Payments	Sync billing and payments with QuickBooks.	Save time on invoicing and improve cash flow management.
Automation	Automate repetitive tasks like follow-up reminders.	Reduce missed deadlines and focus on customer support.

Competitive Analysis

Industry Competitors

MWD Competitors	Field Services Competitors	IT / Professionals Competitors
NetSuite	Jobber	HubSpot
Salesforce	Monday.com	ConnectWise (Potential)
HubSpot	CompanyCam (less competitive/more ancillary)	Syncro (Potential)
Clover POS (POS System & Credit Card Readers | Clover more ancillary vs. competitor)	HubSpot	Other ERP Systems
Zoho	Company-specific tools	
Pipedrive		
Odoo		

Does Salesforce have a two-way sync with QuickBooks?

Yes, Salesforce can have a two-way sync with QuickBooks, allowing for data to flow both ways between the two systems, **but it requires using a third-party integration tool or app, such as DBSync or SyncQ.** Method does not.

Here's a more detailed explanation:

- **Third-Party Integration Tools:**

  Salesforce doesn't have a built-in, native two-way sync with QuickBooks. You'll need to use an app or connector from the Salesforce AppExchange or other vendors.
- **Examples of Integration Tools:**
  - **DBSync:** A cloud-based solution that supports both QuickBooks Online and Desktop, offering bi-directional sync and customization features.
  - **SyncQ:** Another app that facilitates integration between Salesforce and QuickBooks.
- **What gets Synced:**

  Common data points that can be synced include accounts, opportunities, jobs, products, invoices, and more.
- **How it Works:**

  These integrations typically use the QuickBooks Web Connector to connect to QuickBooks Desktop and initiate the sync.

Thryv is another CRM that has two-way sync with QuickBooks but significant limitations compared to Method. **Want to know more? Battlecard: Method vs. Thryv**

Method vs MWD Competitors (NetSuite, Salesforce, HubSpot, Clover POS, Zoho, Pipedrive)

MWD Differentiators

1. **Instant, Two-Way Sync with QuickBooks:**
   - Unlike NetSuite or Salesforce, Method offers real-time sync with QuickBooks, ensuring data accuracy without manual imports.

- Most CRMs only provide limited integration with QuickBooks (e.g., periodic sync or limited data points).

2. **Affordable Customization:**
   - NetSuite and Salesforce offer extensive customization but at a **significantly higher price point**.
   - Method provides enterprise level customization **at SMB friendly prices**, appealing to businesses that don't want to pay ERP level fees.
3. **Tailored Workflows:**
   - Method allows unique business processes (e.g., SKU tracking, custom architecture millwork) that generic CRMs struggle to accommodate.
   - Clover POS lacks bi-directional integration with QuickBooks, which Method supports natively.
4. **Scalable Solution:**
   - While Smartbweb offers kanban style production management, it's limited in scope. Method scales with growing businesses while maintaining customization.

Method vs Field Service Competitors (Jobber, monday.com, CompanyCam, HubSpot, Company-specific scheduling tools)

Field Services Differentiators

1. **Customizable Scheduling & Dispatching:**
   - Unlike Jobber or monday.com, Method allows for **deep customization of scheduling, dispatching, and mobile workflows** to suit unique business models.
2. **Comprehensive QuickBooks Sync:**
   - While HubSpot provides CRM functionalities, it doesn't integrate seamlessly with QuickBooks for end-to-end business management.
   - Jobber offers QuickBooks sync but with **limitations in terms of customization and data control**.
3. **Industry-Specific Customization:**
   - Method caters to niche industries (e.g., home security, painting companies) by allowing users to build **custom processes tailored to their workflows**.
   - Competitors like CompanyCam offer specialized features (e.g., visual project tracking), but Method can integrate these into broader workflows if needed.
4. **Dedicated Enhancement Plans:**
   - Competitors rarely offer ongoing, tailored support. Method's **Dedicated Enhancement Plans** are ideal for customers who require continuous customization.

Method vs IT and Professional Services Competitors (HubSpot, ConnectWise, Syncro, Other ERP Systems)

IT Pro Differentiators

1. **Integration with QuickBooks & Xero:**
   - Unlike ConnectWise or Syncro, which focus on **ticketing and service management**, Method provides **two-way sync with accounting tools** (QuickBooks & Xero), ensuring financial data is always accurate.
2. **Custom Processes for MSPs:**
   - IT Pros often need custom workflows for **recurring invoices, service contracts, asset tracking, and project management**. Method's customization capabilities provide flexibility beyond out-of-the-box solutions.
3. **Cost-Effective Automation:**
   - Unlike ERP systems, which are costly and require extensive implementation, Method provides **affordable automation tools** that work seamlessly with QuickBooks.
4. **Dedicated Consulting & Support:**
   - Competitors like ConnectWise offer support, but Method's **Dedicated Enhancement Plans** provide ongoing enhancements that grow with the customer's needs.

General Differentiators (Summary- All Industries)

What makes Method different?

1. **Enterprise-Level Customization at SMB Prices:** Method provides the depth of customization available in high-end ERPs but at a price point affordable for small and medium-sized businesses.
2. **Instant, Two-Way Sync with QuickBooks:** Unlike many competitors that require manual imports or limited integration, Method ensures data accuracy through real-time sync.
3. **On-Demand Support & Dedicated Enhancement Plans (Battlecard: DEP):** Customers can get tailored help to build the exact tools they need, avoiding the limitations of rigid CRMs.